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Financial reports and audited financial statements, and reports of the Board of Auditors: United Nations peacekeeping operations

Administrative and budgetary aspects of the financing of the United Nations peacekeeping operations

Implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2024

Report of the Secretary-General

Summary

The present report provides information in response to the recommendations of the Board of Auditors contained in its report on United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period from 1 July 2023 to 30 June 2024 ([A/79/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II). The report is submitted in accordance with paragraph 7 of General Assembly resolution [48/216 B](#), in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General, at the same time as the recommendations of the Board of Auditors are submitted to the Assembly, to provide it with his responses and to indicate measures that will be taken to implement those recommendations, with appropriate timetables.

The Administration has concurred with the Board's recommendations and its relevant comments have been duly reflected in the report of the Board. The present report provides additional comments from the Administration, where appropriate, and information on the status of implementation, the department responsible, the estimated completion date and the priority for each recommendation contained in the report of the Board. In addition, the report contains updated information on the status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board relating to the prior periods that were reported by the Board, in annex II to its report, as not having been fully implemented.



I. Introduction

1. In its resolution [48/216](#) B, the General Assembly requested the Secretary-General, at the same time as the recommendations of the Board of Auditors are submitted to the Assembly, to provide it with his responses and to indicate measures that will be taken to implement those recommendations, with appropriate timetables. The present report is submitted in response to the recommendations of the Board contained in its report on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2024 ([A/79/5](#) (Vol. II), chap. II).

2. In preparing the present report, account was taken of the provisions of the following documents:

(a) General Assembly resolution [52/212](#) B, in particular paragraphs 2 to 5 thereof, and the note by the Secretary-General transmitting the proposals of the Board for improving the implementation of its recommendations approved by the Assembly ([A/52/753](#), annex);

(b) Paragraph 5 of Assembly resolution [78/242](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to ensure the full implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors and the related recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions in a prompt and timely manner;

(c) Paragraph 6 of Assembly resolution [78/242](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to continue to indicate an expected time frame for the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors and the priorities for their implementation, including the office holders to be held accountable and measures taken in that regard;

(d) Paragraph 7 of Assembly resolution [78/242](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to provide, in his next report on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations, a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of all outstanding recommendations of the Board, the root causes of the recurring issues and the measures to be taken.

3. With regard to prioritization, the Administration noted that the Board had categorized 24 of the 35 recommendations for the period ended 30 June 2024 as “main recommendations”. While all the accepted recommendations of the Board will be implemented in a timely manner, the main recommendations are considered to be of the highest priority.

4. The status of implementation of the new recommendations as of February 2025 is summarized in tables 1 and 2.

5. As indicated in table 1, of the 24 main recommendations issued by the Board, closure has been requested for 1 and the other 23 remained under implementation as of February 2025; of those, 10 have been targeted for implementation before the end of 2025 and 13 before the end of 2026.

Table 1
Status of implementation of the main recommendations of the Board of Auditors as of February 2025

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	6	—	—	6	6	—
Department of Operational Support	6	—	—	6	6	—
Department of Peace Operations	1	—	—	1	1	—
United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy	1	—	1	—	—	—
Multiple entities	10	—	—	10	10	—
Total	24	—	1	23	23	—

6. As indicated in table 2, of the 35 new recommendations issued by the Board, closure has been requested for 2. The remaining 33 were under implementation as of February 2025, with 14 targeted for implementation before the end of 2025, 18 before the end of 2026 and 1 before the end of 2027.

Table 2
Status of implementation of all recommendations (including main ones) of the Board of Auditors as of February 2025

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	7	—	—	7	7	—
Department of Operational Support	9	—	1	8	8	—
Department of Peace Operations	1	—	—	1	1	—
United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy	1	—	1	—	—	—
Multiple entities	17	—	—	17	17	—
Total	35	—	2	33	33	—

II. Administration's comments regarding specific findings by the Board of Auditors

Payables

Due diligence controls regarding performance assurances documents provided by contractors

7. In paragraph 49 of its report, the Board stated that, during 2023/24, at the request of the Procurement Division, the Office of Internal Oversight Services investigated a procurement issue in two peacekeeping missions. As at 30 June 2024, a significant presumptive fraud amount had been reported to the Board regarding that case.

8. In paragraph 50 of its report, the Board stated that, from 2018 to 2021, a vendor had provided guarantee letters to the Procurement Division. When the contractor was shown to be in breach of contract, the Division initiated the process of withdrawing the performance guarantees owing to damages incurred by the United Nations, but this was not possible because it appeared that those performance guarantees had been forged. According to the Office of Internal Oversight Services investigation, it was established that the forged performance guarantees were allegedly made by a bank that had already gone into liquidation, even prior to the issuance of the first performance guarantees. Through the standard process to request and obtain performance guarantees, the fraudulent nature of the guarantee letters could not be detected when the written assurances were received.

9. The Administration would like to state that the performance guarantees were received and processed following the standard practice. During the life of the contracts, the Office of Supply Chain Management, following the relevant standard procedure, secured performance assurances from the contractor, which were sufficient to cover the expenses paid by the United Nations as a result of the contractor's non-performance. When the Office of Supply Chain Management approached the issuing bank to withdraw those assurances, it learned that the documents that had been submitted by the contractor were forgeries.

10. The Office of Supply Chain Management is exploring, with the United Nations Treasury, the possibility of discontinuing the use of paper-based performance assurances in favour of those transmitted electronically (e.g. through Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT) messages), which would enable the detection of forgeries. As is stated by the Board, in paragraph 49 of its report, the Office of Supply Chain Management immediately reported the matter to the Office of Internal Oversight Services, whose assessment determined a proscribed practice on the part of the contractor.

11. It should be noted that, while the case has revealed the need to reinforce certain processes, the misconduct relates to the contractor, not to United Nations staff.

Deficiencies in fuel management

Fuel crisis in the United Nations Support Office in Somalia

12. In paragraph 220 of its report, the Board indicated that the audit of the United Nations Support Office in Somalia (UNSOS) had revealed a dire fuel crisis caused by the failure of the fuel contractor (hereinafter referred to as "contractor A") to perform several of its obligations in accordance with the terms and conditions of its contract with the United Nations, which had placed the mission at risk in terms of its fuel supply. Several urgent mitigating measures, including procurement actions, had been taken to ensure the supply of fuel.

13. In paragraph 222 of the Board's report, the Secretariat stated that, following the receipt from the mission of the compilation of potential claims due to contractor A's failure to perform its contractual obligations, efforts were ongoing regarding the next steps that could be taken against the contractor and/or the issuer of the performance guarantee in relation to the contract.

14. The Administration notes that contractor A had been supplying fuel to UNSOS since 2016, with satisfactory performance. However, the unforeseen risks posed by extraneous factors, such as global supply chain challenges and rising fuel and shipping prices in the wake of the armed conflict in Ukraine, had created an economic environment, in 2022, that contractor A's financial strength had been unable to withstand.

15. The performance guarantee was confirmed by the issuer as valid security and was processed by the Procurement Division in the customary way. Action can therefore be taken against the issuer of the performance guarantee.

Claims processing

Transversal issues

16. In paragraph 286 of its report, the Board stated that information on the actual payment dates was lacking in 8 out of 40 files from the sample.

17. The Administration wishes to clarify that, with regard to the availability of information to Member States pertaining to the actual payment dates, that information had already been made available in the Uniformed Capabilities Management System and on the Member States Portal for Uniformed Capabilities Support, including in cases when the delay was owing to the unavailability of cash.

III. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors

18. The information requested by the General Assembly on the status of implementation of recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the financial period ended 30 June 2024 (A/79/5 (Vol. II), chap. II) is set out below. As indicated in the summary of the present report, most of the Administration's comments have already been included in the report of the Board. Accordingly, additional comments are provided only where deemed necessary.

19. In paragraph 52 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen due diligence controls on contract administration regarding performance assurances provided by contractors, in order to verify their authenticity.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

20. The Department of Operational Support has requested support from the United Nations Treasury to enable the receipt of performance assurances via SWIFT message through the United Nations Treasury SWIFT infrastructure, as opposed to receiving paper-based securities, as has been the practice of the Organization to date. However, this approach represents additional workload for the United Nations Treasury and, depending on the volume of performance assurances being received and the extent of United Nations Treasury involvement, additional resources might be required. The Department would also like to perform credit checks on the institutions issuing performance assurances, which would mean engaging appropriately qualified financial agencies or banks to perform creditworthiness checks. Such services would come at a cost but would enable a much more robust system to mitigate fraud by vendors and would provide for a mechanism to assess the creditworthiness of the guarantors' issuing institutions.

21. In paragraph 91 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration either identify all its eligible retirees and their dependants who had accumulated after-service health insurance benefits and estimate their after-

service health insurance benefits or liabilities as at the date for financial reporting in peacekeeping operations as reported in volume II, or, if not possible, document and formalize the use of the 17 per cent apportionment rate in determining the share of peacekeeping operations in total actual after-service health insurance costs.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: First quarter of 2026

22. The rate of apportionment of after-service health insurance pay-as-you-go costs between peacekeeping operations and other fund types is currently under internal review, with necessary actuarial input being developed by an external actuary. The outcome of the review will provide the data needed to determine and support the after-service health insurance apportionment rate for peacekeeping operations.

23. In paragraph 102 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to document and monitor the after-service health insurance enrolment rate of eligible participants and their eligible dependants in order to improve the accuracy of the after-service health insurance liabilities valuation, by, among others, including the United Nations Staff Mutual Insurance Society against Sickness and Accident experience and the experience of longer periods under the United Nations Medical Insurance Plan.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: First quarter of 2026

24. The Administration is collecting the necessary data to broaden the basis for the calculation of the actuarial assumption for the after-service health insurance enrolment rate.

25. In paragraph 114 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the process of staff advances that are not subject to automatic recovery from Umoja, including clearing actions, periodic assessment for impairment and the responsibility levels among missions, the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda, and United Nations Headquarters.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Second quarter of 2025

26. Meetings will be held with responsible entities including missions, the Regional Service Centre and offices at Headquarters in order to develop an action plan.

27. In paragraph 148 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration improve the documentation regarding the process for the

creation of the scheduling of write-offs, in accordance with regulation 6.5 of the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations, through a standard operating procedure.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

28. As recommended by the Board, the Administration will develop a standard operating procedure to document the creation of the scheduling of write-offs.

29. In paragraph 167 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration prioritize and expedite the implementation of a cost-recovery dashboard in order to provide client-type categorization (at least for agencies, funds and programmes) and to strengthen internal controls over cost recovery, especially by providing, on a rolling basis, data linked with Umoja relating to receivables, net asset position, revenue and expenses by mission.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Second quarter of 2025

30. The Administration is working to prioritize the completion of the dashboard and expects to release the first version by the end of June 2025.

31. In paragraph 200 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration finalize the budget transfer of the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy, and the Regional Service Centre tenant units by unifying the processes for budget reports, results-based budgeting frameworks and enterprise risk management at the Logistics Base and Regional Service Centre levels.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Second quarter of 2025

32. The Secretariat will present the transfer of these tenant units from the budgets of the United Nations Logistics Base and the Regional Service Centre to the budgets of their parent departments for the 2025/26 period in order to address the challenges noted by the Board.

33. In paragraph 236 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consider either: (a) enhancing the disclosure in the notes to the financial statements by including the total number and value of fully depreciated assets still in use, and their percentage, compared with the total amount of property, plant and equipment, in a disaggregated manner by asset class and by

mission; or (b) presenting that information to Member States in the context of the report of the Secretary-General on the overview of peacekeeping operations.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

34. The Administration will consider making the disclosures recommended by the Board.

35. In paragraph 261 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration prepare an issues paper for the consideration of the 2026 Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment in which the challenges of the current methodology are highlighted and the mandating of a study to encourage more efficient gathering and use of national cost data is proposed.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

36. The Administration will present to the 2026 Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment an issues paper in which the mandating of a study will be proposed. Further implementation will be based on the recommendations of the Working Group and the decisions of the General Assembly.

37. In paragraph 287 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration process the contingent-owned equipment damage claims for hostile action or force abandonment within the targeted 90 days of receipt of claims from Member States, complete with documentation.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Third quarter of 2025

38. The Administration will brief troop- and police-contributing countries to ensure that they are aware of the documentation required for force abandonment and hostile action claims. It will prioritize the processing of such claims as soon as complete documentation is received.

39. In paragraph 302 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration prepare a contribution on environmental issues before the next Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment, in 2026, that identifies the areas in which improvement is most needed and examines where the rules should be clarified, where enhanced reimbursement rates might be introduced and where provisions might be made binding.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

40. The Administration will draft issues papers on environmental matters, including on expanding the reimbursement rates for larger solar photovoltaic and energy storage systems, for the consideration of the 2026 Working Group.

41. In paragraph 324 of its report, the Board recommended that the revision of Action for Peacekeeping Plus include an analysis of the reasons for the fluctuation of some key performance indicators of priority 5 (accountability of peacekeepers).

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

42. The Administration will analyse the reasons for the fluctuation of some key performance indicators on the accountability of peacekeepers and identify where appropriate attention needs to be paid, including with regard to training and overall performance-related matters. The analysis will feed into future revisions of the Action for Peacekeeping Plus initiative.

43. In paragraph 331 of its report, the Board recommended that the Department of Peace Operations take the opportunity of the revision of Action for Peacekeeping Plus to propose solutions to engage the missions in the implementation of and follow-up on Action for Peacekeeping Plus priorities.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

44. Starting with the publication of the sixth Action for Peacekeeping Plus progress report, in February 2025, the Department of Peace Operations will engage with missions to discuss and support strategies for enhancing the internal and external dissemination of findings and to obtain feedback on how to improve the indicator framework and the presentation of findings. This will inform the revision of Action for Peacekeeping Plus and help to strengthen missions' engagement in the implementation of and follow-up on Action for Peacekeeping Plus priorities. The overall implementation of the recommendation is subject to the continued availability of the extrabudgetary resources on which the coordination of Action for Peacekeeping Plus efforts depends.

45. In paragraph 344 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen scenario-based planning and regular planning exercises, in particular for missions that operate in volatile environments, to ensure that missions can identify and respond to risks and be ready to adjust their postures as circumstances change.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

46. The Department of Peace Operations will support the development and updating, as relevant, of mission concepts and mission plans across peacekeeping operations in accordance with the forthcoming Department of Peace Operations, Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Department of Operational Support guidelines on the mission concept and mission plan. It is expected that these exercises will include scenario-building to inform the underlying analysis, the development of plans and the assessment and management of risk. The Department of Peace Operations is also leveraging scenario planning in the development of military concepts of operations.

47. In paragraph 350 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration finalize the review and update of the strategic and operational plans of the United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO) to align them with the new mandate and approach to the Mission's disengagement.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and MONUSCO

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

48. Following the adoption of Security Council resolution [2765 \(2024\)](#) on the situation concerning the Democratic Republic of the Congo, the Department of Peace Operations updated the mission concept, which will serve as the basis for the review of strategic planning documents, including the force and the police concepts of operations, and the development of a protection of civilians strategy and mission plan.

49. In paragraph 362 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration systematically include early transition planning in the mission planning to ensure readiness and promote proactivity, with due consideration given to specific mandates and contexts.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

50. As part of its support in the development or updating of mission concepts and mission plans across peacekeeping operations, in accordance with the forthcoming guidelines on the mission concept and mission plan, the Department of Peace Operations will encourage missions to include early transition planning, as relevant to their mandate and context, as part of their planning exercises.

51. In paragraph 363 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen resources to fund transition planning in the

Secretariat and, in particular, in the Department of Peace Operations, the Development Coordination Office and the Department of Operational Support.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations, Development Coordination Office and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

52. The Administration is developing an institutionalization plan, with the aim of strengthening transition-planning capacity in the Secretariat. The Administration will make efforts to secure resources for transition planning, as the financial situation permits.

53. In paragraph 364 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration finalize its transition preparedness tool in consultation with all stakeholders and ensure its dissemination in all peacekeeping operations, with regular follow-up from United Nations Headquarters on progress of the preparedness reviews.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2026

54. The initial version of the transition preparedness tool was produced using existing resources. However, future iterations of the tool and the creation of a digital platform for the tool will require additional resources that are not currently available. The Administration will make efforts to secure resources, as the financial situation permits, to fully develop the tool as intended. Meanwhile, the Department of Operational Support will continue to engage with missions and assist in the preparations and planning for transitions.

55. In paragraph 374 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat monitor the risk of Peacekeeping Capability Readiness System verification visits becoming dependent on extrabudgetary funding, assess whether the requisite visits can be conducted and, if not, propose mitigating actions to seek more sustainable funding sources.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

56. The Administration will continue to monitor the availability of extrabudgetary funding for verification visits.

57. In paragraph 395 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration improve strategic deployment stocks management by finding the right balance between the ability for rapid deployment of the start-up phase of a

peacekeeping mission and the management of the risk of strategic deployment stocks obsolescence, in line with the most recent guidance issued by the Department of Operational Support to the United Nations Logistics Base.

Department responsible: United Nations Logistics Base

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Target date: Not applicable

58. The United Nations Logistics Base has incorporated measures to improve management of strategic deployment stocks in the 2025/26 budget proposal. These measures are aimed at balancing the rapid deployment needs of mission start-up phases with effective risk management of strategic deployment stocks obsolescence. In the revised strategic deployment stocks framework, holistic solutions and strategic stock locations are emphasized, providing for a broader scope that includes disaster response, health emergencies and ongoing operations. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

59. In paragraph 410 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat propose regulatory developments with a view to facilitating the disposal process of unserviceable contingent-owned equipment and thereby address the existing backlog within the peacekeeping operations' troop- and police-contributing countries.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and
Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Third quarter of 2026

60. The Administration will present an issues paper for consideration by Member States in the upcoming 2026 Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment; if approved, appropriate text will be included in the Contingent-Owned Equipment Manual.

61. In paragraph 421 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat (Department of Operational Support and Department of Peace Operations) issue guidance to field missions to organize regular meetings for the weapons and ammunition advisory boards and that the Headquarters contingent-owned equipment and memorandum of understanding management review board ensure comprehensive monitoring of the advisory boards' activities.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and
Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

62. The Administration will monitor the status of the meetings of missions' weapons and ammunition advisory boards and provide guidance to them, as recommended.

63. **In paragraph 427 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration complete the implementation of the new ammunition module tool in accordance with the established road map.**

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and
Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

64. In accordance with the established road map, the first phase of implementation of the new ammunition module tool has been completed. Progress is being made towards implementing the next phase.

65. **In paragraph 428 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clearly define the responsibilities associated with the new ammunition management module at the local level (peacekeeping operation) and at the central level (Headquarters) in terms of the second line of defence in a dedicated standard operating procedure once the project is completed.**

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and
Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: First quarter of 2027

66. The Administration will take the necessary action to implement the recommendation and will work towards the drafting of a standard operating procedure, with clearly defined responsibilities associated with the new ammunition management module.

67. **In paragraph 434 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat assist the United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS) in lifting prohibitions on the disposal of ammunition and/or in rapidly identifying alternative solutions.**

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and
Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

68. Headquarters is coordinating with the Mission to identify and work on the most feasible options.

69. **In paragraph 451 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include environmental considerations in core category strategies to mitigate environmental risks.**

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

70. Currently, environmental considerations are included in many core category strategies. The Administration is making a concerted effort to more explicitly include sustainability considerations, including environmental considerations, in each of its core supply chain categories, as applicable.

71. In paragraph 455 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat propose solutions to Member States on the accumulation of waste in troop- and police-contributing countries' camps.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and
 Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

72. The Administration will explore ways to further encourage troop- and police-contributing countries to reduce the generation of solid waste and reduce the stockpiling of various waste streams in the camps of troop- and police-contributing countries during the mission sustainment phase, in particular in the context of the ongoing review of the environmental handbook for military commanders.

73. In paragraph 462 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration sustain the Rapid Environment and Climate Technical Assistance team project with the aim of concluding a longer-term United Nations-United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS) agreement with optional extensions.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Third quarter of 2026

74. The recent agreement signed between the Department of Operational Support and UNOPS extended the mandate of the Rapid Environment and Climate Technical Assistance team until 31 July 2026. Options to sustain the team beyond that date will be explored in line with the period covered by the document entitled "The way forward: environment strategy for peace operations 2023–2030".

75. In paragraph 466 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review applicable standard unit requirements to consider, when relevant, the reduced energy production requirements following an evaluation by specialized electrical engineers.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

76. The Administration highlights that the generic standard unit requirements will be reviewed to further encourage a reduction in the use of diesel fuel in electricity generation by troop- and police-contributing countries, including through a more efficient use of diesel generators, the integration of renewable energy systems into electricity generation and other energy efficiency measures, in line with findings from recent energy assessments conducted by the Department of Operational Support energy experts in troop- and police-contributing countries' camps.

77. In paragraph 471 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to include in future solicitations hybrid and carbon-neutral vehicles in order to allow them to expand their use in missions through improved adaptation to the local constraints and needs.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

78. The Department of Operational Support currently has two global system contracts offering hybrid vehicles and seven global system contracts for the supply of vehicles that comply with the latest Euro 5/6 emissions standards (carbon neutral). The seven contracts supply airport firefighting trucks, armoured passenger vehicles, minibuses, light passenger vehicles, and light and heavy trucks. The vehicles and equipment supplied under these contracts require ultra-low sulfur diesel of no more than 10 parts per million to operate correctly and become carbon neutral. These vehicles can be deployed to field missions wherever and whenever the required diesel fuel is available. The Department of Operational Support will continue to pursue the use of hybrid and carbon-neutral vehicles beyond existing contracts and to document its efforts to engage clients in identifying and meeting local constraints and requirements. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

79. In paragraph 503 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, when a mission closure occurs, seek predictable funding resources for mechanisms that ensure engagement to address residual peace challenges.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations, Development Coordination Office, Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

80. The Administration will review various options to provide funding for mechanisms to address residual peace challenges following the closure of missions.

81. In paragraph 512 of its report, the Board recommended that all closing missions produce a comprehensive lessons learned report to be submitted to United Nations Headquarters upon their closure.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

82. The Department of Peace Operations will update the policy on knowledge management and organizational learning to reflect the recommendation and provide advice to closing or transitioning peacekeeping missions so as to ensure that various funding mechanisms are used for the exercise. It will provide substantive support to missions preparing comprehensive lessons learned reports.

83. In paragraph 551 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure the geographical co-location of integrated teams, as guided and supported by Headquarters-level joint mechanisms, in peacekeeping settings, wherever possible.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations, Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs, United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic, MONUSCO and UNMISS

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

84. The Department of Peace Operations will guide and support peacekeeping operations on the physical co-location of integrated teams, when relevant for mandate implementation and their operational and programmatic context. Final decisions on physical co-location will rest with the missions and relevant agencies, funds and programmes, with due consideration given to budgetary implications.

85. In paragraph 604 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat foster, on the basis of the experience in the Democratic Republic of the Congo and in other transition settings, and where appropriate, the signing of memorandums of understanding with the agencies, funds and programmes to frame and strengthen relationships during transition periods, and develop the expertise of United Nations staff by incorporating transition knowledge and, if possible, create a pool of transition specialists, to deploy in support of mission and United Nations country team planning to ensure effective transitions.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations, Development Coordination Office and Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2026

86. The Department of Peace Operations will pursue efforts to share the experience in the Democratic Republic of the Congo with other relevant missions. In relation to transition expertise, the Department of Peace Operations and the Development Coordination Office, as partners in the United Nations Transitions Project (along with the United Nations Development Programme and the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs), are developing an institutionalization plan, with the aim of strengthening transition-planning capacity in the Secretariat.

87. In paragraph 647 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat raise, at the High-level Committee on Management, the issue of promoting inter-agency mobility in the human resources management policies of the entities of the United Nations common system.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

88. The Secretariat will raise, in 2025, the topic of inter-agency mobility in the Human Resources Network of the High-level Committee on Management, for further discussion and consultation.

IV. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the reports of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations for prior financial periods

89. In paragraph 7 of its resolution [78/242 B](#), the General Assembly requested that the Secretary-General provide, in his next report on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations, a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of all outstanding recommendations of the Board, the root causes of the recurring issues and the measures to be taken. Such explanations have been included in the Administration's detailed comments below relating to the relevant recommendations.

90. In annex II to its report on United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period from 1 July 2023 to 30 June 2024 ([A/79/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II), the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation of its 53 extant recommendations issued during the six prior financial periods up to 30 June 2023. Of the 53 extant recommendations, 14 (26 per cent) were assessed as "implemented", 38 (72 per cent) as "under implementation" and 1 (2 per cent) as "overtaken by events". The Board also noted in its report that only 26 (49 per cent) of the 53 extant recommendations had been endorsed by the General Assembly as at 30 June 2024.

91. As at 30 June 2024, the overall status of implementation of all of the Board's recommendations issued since the 2017/18 financial period up until the 2022/23 financial period (that is, over the six prior financial periods) is shown in table 3.

Table 3

Overall status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors from six prior financial periods up to 30 June 2023

<i>Financial period</i>	<i>Report symbol</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Fully implemented</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Overtaken by events</i>
2017/18	A/73/5 (Vol. II)	52	37 (71%)	3 (6%)	12 (23%)
2018/19	A/74/5 (Vol. II)	43	40 (93%)	1 (2%)	2 (5%)
2019/20	A/75/5 (Vol. II)	30	26 (87%)	1 (3%)	3 (10%)
2020/21	A/76/5 (Vol. II)	10	7 (70%)	2 (20%)	1 (10%)
2021/22	A/77/5 (Vol. II)	20	8 (40%)	12 (60%)	–
2022/23	A/78/5 (Vol. II)	26	6 (23%)	19 (73%)	1 (4%)
Totals:		181	124 (69%)	38 (21%)	19 (10%)

92. Table 4 provides a detailed analysis of the status of implementation, as of February 2025, of the 38 extant recommendations from the prior periods that had been assessed by the Board as being “under implementation”.

Table 4

Status of implementation of the outstanding recommendations of the Board of Auditors from prior periods as of February 2025

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	20	3	17	17	–
Department of Operational Support	3	1	2	2	–
Department of Peace Operations	3	–	3	3	–
Multiple entities	12	6	6	6	–
Total	38	10	28	28	–

93. Of the 38 recommendations that were assessed by the Board as being under implementation, the Administration has requested the closure of 10. As of February 2025, the remaining 28 were under implementation, of which 24 are targeted for implementation before the end of 2025 and 4 in 2026.

A. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2018 ([A/73/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II)

94. In paragraph 209 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse the direct and indirect costs associated with the disposal of unserviceable and expired ammunition from troop- and/or police-contributing countries and inform Member States accordingly.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Ongoing
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

95. Ammunition management is a task for which responsibility is shared across the Organization, including several departments and missions. When the Department of Operational Support was established, in 2019, ammunition management was not a task envisaged for the Department, for which reason it was not resourced with a specialist to carry out that task. The Department identified the need for resources to perform specialized work on ammunition to be included in the Support Account budget proposals for the 2021/22 financial period and then in the 2022/23 financial period. Given the overall financial situation, however, the decision was taken not to request additional resources for that purpose. In addition, the Department explored the possibility of obtaining an expert as gratis personnel, but no nominations were received. Ultimately, the Department conducted its own assessment and analysis, as recommended by the Board, by overstretching its existing resources. It gave a briefing to Member States on the analysis of ammunition costs in a meeting held on 4 December 2024. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

96. In paragraph 407 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration amend the policy for rosters with the objective to facilitate roster-building, management and data cleansing.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2019
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

97. Decisions of the Secretary-General on roster management were made following discussions at the Staff-Management Committee meeting held in April 2023. These decisions were incorporated into a revision of the administrative instruction on the staff selection system, which is currently under review.

98. In paragraph 417 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the recruitment process to increase transparency and simplify and shorten the procedure.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2019
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

99. The Administration has taken a number of steps through the various revisions of the administrative instruction on the staff selection system (ST/AI/2010/3), as well as other administrative instructions, to ensure that the recruitment process is simpler and more transparent and that the overall procedure is shorter and adaptable to the current needs of the Organization. Notable updates include the amendment to the administrative instruction issued in 2017 (ST/AI/2010/3/Amend.3), by which the deadline of applying for regular job openings in the Professional and higher categories was reduced from 60 to 45 days. Furthermore, in 2023, the Administration issued an administrative instruction on downsizing or restructuring resulting in termination of appointments (ST/AI/2023/1), whereby it determined that no roster selections could be made for job openings or temporary job openings before the job opening posting period had closed. This will further reduce the overall recruitment timeline by enabling hiring managers to make selections faster.

100. In 2018, the United Nations Global Centre for Human Resources Services was established in Bonn, Germany, to streamline and standardize and provide job classification advice and notices using the master standards promulgated by the International Civil Service Commission. In addition, the Centre launched a reference-checking process, through which employment background, academic records and qualitative references are checked.

101. Lastly, automated tools were introduced in Inspira in 2019, specifically in relation to the screening process. These include the job fit questionnaire and an interview evaluation feature for expedited reporting on competency-based interviews. Another feature introduced in Inspira in 2019 was the candidate summary feature, which displays a summary of key data from the application profile and the job fit questionnaire on one page as well as analytics related to the diversity of the candidate pool. In 2020, the candidate summary was supplemented by the applied criteria tool to support the definition and recording of the methodology used by the hiring manager in the preliminary evaluation. Those recruitment innovations have enabled hiring managers to accelerate both the screening and evaluation processes.

102. In view of the incremental revisions made to the staff selection system policy, process and technological tools since the recommendation was issued, the Administration requests closure of the recommendation.

B. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2019 (A/74/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

103. In paragraph 202 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration extend the delegation of authority portals' functionalities to specify and limit subdelegations to ensure that the staff member who receives subdelegations is aware of the scope.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2020
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

104. The Administration has developed and tested an enhanced delegation of authority portal, which has more detailed and explicit scope of authorities with regard

to subdelegations. The enhanced portal will be rolled out when the revised Secretary-General's bulletin on delegation of authority and the delegation of authority instrument are published, which is expected to be in 2025. Implementation of this recommendation was delayed owing to resource constraints and competing priorities.

C. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2020 (A/75/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

105. In paragraph 68 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration determine the support account share of after-service health insurance expenditure on the basis of actual costs incurred within peacekeeping operations.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2026

106. The rate of apportionment for after-service health insurance pay-as-you-go costs for peacekeeping operations and other fund types is currently under internal review, with necessary actuarial input being developed by an external actuary. The outcome of the review will provide the data needed to determine and support the after-service health insurance apportionment rate for peacekeeping operations.

D. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2021 (A/76/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

107. In paragraph 57 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration determine which categories of assets the missions shall provide to UNOPS for mine action projects and exclude them from financial agreements with UNOPS, include provisions on periodic asset reporting by UNOPS that facilitate International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS) financial reporting in the new memorandum of understanding, and integrate the Chiefs of the Mine Action Programme into the oversight and management of project assets.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

108. The memorandum of understanding signed on 30 April 2024 is between the entire United Nations Secretariat and UNOPS and hence does not mention any

specific arrangements related to an individual office. The memorandum of understanding was, in fact, never expected to contain such elements, since the responsibilities of the Chiefs of the Mine Action Programme were already detailed in the Mine Action Service standard operating procedure on asset management and disposal, which was issued on 1 July 2023 and shared with the Board to demonstrate that the first part of the recommendation (categories of assets excluded from financial agreements) and the third (integration of the chiefs into the oversight and management of project assets) had already been implemented by that date. Since the memorandum of understanding was signed in April 2024, the Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

109. In paragraph 74 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the delegation of authority to any Officers-in-Charge is visible in the delegation of authority portal, and define and codify the delegation of authority for administrative decisions regarding the management of resources, including human resources, for all drawdown and liquidation activities after the Security Council mandate of a mission has ended.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

110. The Administration has put in place interim policy arrangements, such as the modalities for delegating authority to an officer-in-charge and regarding the exercise of delegated authority at the start-up and closure of a mission. The recommendation will be fully implemented following publication of the revised Secretary-General's bulletin on delegation of authority in the administration of the Staff Regulations and Rules and the Financial Regulations and Rules ([ST/SGB/2019/2](#)), which codifies these interim arrangements in a single policy document. The revised Secretary-General's bulletin and instrument are in the final review stage and are expected to be published in 2025. An enhanced delegation of authority portal will be rolled out alongside the revised policy. Implementation of this recommendation was delayed owing to resource constraints and competing priorities.

E. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2022 ([A/77/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II)

111. In paragraph 50 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration organize an annual “peacekeeping risk management day”, in order to raise awareness and develop, including through proper brainstorming and training sessions, a more risk-aware culture in the peacekeeping missions.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	First quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

112. To support risk awareness and develop a more risk-aware culture, the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance conducted site visits in 2024 to assist two peacekeeping missions – MONUSCO and UNSOS – with their risk assessments. Furthermore, to raise awareness of fraud and corruption, in 2023 the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance developed training on raising awareness of fraud and corruption, which is accessible through the Capacity Development and Operational Training Service campus and is a complement to the Fraud and Corruption Awareness Handbook. In December 2024, the Department published an iSeek article entitled “Join the fight against corruption”, which is available to all entities in the Secretariat.

113. The enterprise risk management focal points’ workshop, initially planned for March 2024, was delayed owing to the Secretariat’s liquidity constraints. It is now expected to be held in the second quarter of 2025, subject to the availability of resources. The workshop will include a dedicated session on peacekeeping risk awareness, during which field missions will engage in facilitated brainstorming in order to identify key risk areas, foster awareness and strengthen the risk-conscious culture.

114. In paragraph 75 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide, with a view to building a more consensual, sound and practical basis for risk-taking in peacekeeping operations, the appropriate elements to fuel a strategic discussion at the level of the legislative bodies, not excluding the issuance of a peacekeeping risk appetite statement and the revision of the 2011 risk management policy.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

115. Pursuant to General Assembly resolutions [66/257](#) and [77/253](#) B, the Assembly is responsible for determining the risk tolerance of the Organization. The Administration has promoted the development of a robust governance framework in all peacekeeping operations, including through the establishment of local risk management committees tasked with overseeing risks and facilitating strategic discussions on risk-taking in all missions. Implementation of this recommendation was delayed owing to the required and ongoing consultations with subject matter experts on the potential development of a peacekeeping risk appetite statement.

116. The Administration is currently revising the 2011 enterprise risk management policy for review by and the approval of the Management Committee.

117. In paragraph 76 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration progressively develop mechanisms to define acceptable risk-

taking at the level of peacekeeping missions and experiment with ways to better incentivize and reward it.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

118. The definition of acceptable risk-taking mechanisms is closely tied to the concept of risk tolerance. However, the development of clear and objective rules and mechanisms for acceptable risk-taking remains a complex endeavour in the context of the Secretariat and requires a culture change. To address the issue, the Office of Human Resources rolled out various managerial tools and frameworks encouraging risk-taking by looking for new and improved ways to deliver on programmes. For example, in the old United Nations Competencies for the Future tool, risk-taking was emphasized in both the managerial and core competencies. Under the “vision” competency, identifying strategic issues, opportunities and risks was one of the behavioural indicators that demonstrated the competency in practice. Similarly, under the “managing performance” competency, one of the behavioural indicators was to encourage risk-taking and support creativity and initiative. Furthermore, under the new United Nations Values and Behaviours Framework, the Office of Human Resources encourages reasoned decision-making, including risk-taking. For example, under the “analyse and plan” behaviour, senior leaders are expected to detect and interpret early signals, new and emerging trends, opportunities and risks. Similarly, under the “deliver results with positive impact” behaviour, senior leaders are expected to take calculated risks, as necessary. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

119. In paragraph 139 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clarify the roles of the first and second lines of defence in the management of risks in peacekeeping operations, taking concrete steps to increase their empowerment, involvement and accountability, and formalizing in particular the participation of the Department of Peace Operations to the second line of defence.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	First quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

120. The Administration is revising the 2011 enterprise risk management policy; consultations with relevant stakeholders are ongoing. The updated policy is intended to clarify the roles and responsibilities of the first and second lines of defence in managing risk, including the specific functions of the Department of Peace Operations. Once completed, the revised policy will be presented to the Management Committee for endorsement. The delay in the implementation of this recommendation is attributed to competing priorities.

121. In paragraph 168 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration assign the responsibility of Chief Risk Officer to an existing senior executive in each entity, at the department, missions and service centres levels.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Department of Peace Operations and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Not applicable

122. In all peacekeeping missions, senior-level staff are already overseeing enterprise risk management at a strategic level, often functioning as de facto chief risk officers. For instance, local risk management committees in peacekeeping missions are typically chaired by the Chief of Staff and/or the Chief of Mission Support. The outcomes of these meetings are often subsequently communicated to the mission's senior leadership, including the special representatives and deputy special representatives of the Secretary-General, thereby ensuring alignment and informed decision-making. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

123. In paragraph 171 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review in the coming months, through a process including all stakeholders, the quality of the existing "risk registers" and "risk treatment and response plans".

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Initial target date: First quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Not applicable

124. The deployment of the Umoja enterprise risk management module across all peacekeeping operations by 31 December 2024 involves a detailed review of the risk registers to strengthen their alignment with the overall policy and methodology, thereby ensuring consistency and improved quality of risk registers and risk treatment and response plans in all missions. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

125. In paragraph 204 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a thorough review of all the existing accountability requirements on peacekeeping operations, in order to streamline and reduce the burden on managers ("simplification shock"), as well as to better articulate risk management with key internal control, strategic programming, budgeting and performance frameworks and ensure data-sharing and interconnected information systems.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2026

126. Considerable progress has been made towards streamlining and reducing the burden on managers. A detailed inventory of reporting requirements was developed and used to identify significant opportunities to simplify reporting requests from Headquarters. The proposals under review or implementation range from filling data gaps, automating reporting when data exist in Umoja and creating interface and data transfers between reporting platforms across departments. Obsolete paper-based forms have been decommissioned, and a peer review process has been established to inform the design of new reporting requirements, allowing for the sharing of ideas on existing data sources and lessons learned.

127. The next phase of the project will continue to explore the feasibility of opportunities to rationalize and tailor or stop reporting requirements. Envisaged benefits include but are not limited to:

- (a) Reducing the overall number, complexity or frequency of reporting requirements;
- (b) Increasing automation and data-sharing;
- (c) Removing reporting duplications or closing data gaps to better support decision-making;
- (d) Adopting new approaches to reporting processes, such as by tailoring requirements or sampling entities, on the basis of relevance and mandates.

128. An implementation schedule is being developed to outline the planned review sequence.

129. In paragraph 222 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration issue a standard operating procedure for cross-borrowing starting with the cash shortfall identification and ending with the loan movement in Umoja. This standard operating procedure shall also include a template note with all relevant information for the approval. Finally, the standard operating procedure should provide that the heads of missions affected are informed.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

130. The draft standard operating procedure is undergoing review and redrafting because it also requires updates pertaining to the current liquidity management of peacekeeping operations and alignment with liquidity management procedures for the regular budget.

131. In paragraph 274 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formalize a policy document for the actuarial valuation of employee benefits that gives an overview of the process and related internal controls. In particular, the policy should describe and document the significant decisions and assumptions to be included in the employee benefits valuation.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

132. The analysis is ongoing, and the Administration will discuss the progress and review the timeline with the Board during the next interim audit.

133. In paragraph 285 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration systematically document the review and the update of volume II employee benefits actuarial assumptions, providing appropriate evidence as necessary, to ensure their reasonableness before using them in the valuation.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

134. The analysis is ongoing, and the Administration will discuss the progress and review the timeline with the Board during the next interim audit.

135. In paragraph 311 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct at least annually a qualitative review of all Umoja user accounts and roles granted in the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance. This review should include making the necessary modifications and deprovisioning user accounts to avoid having any active accounts with legacy privileges.

Departments responsible: Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: First quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2026

136. The user access functional subgroup continues its work on reviewing the process and scope for a regular review of Umoja access and role provisioning.

137. In paragraph 325 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration rework key performance indicators for demand planning, set targets to be reached and ensure a follow-up of the results.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: First quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

138. The Department of Operational Support has completed a working version of the key performance indicators dashboard, incorporating sample data from four client entities, following a thorough analysis of the relevant key performance indicators for supply chain planning. After initial review, the dashboard has been distributed to multiple entities, accompanied by a survey to elicit feedback. The dashboard will be finalized after giving due consideration to the feedback from entities and will be operationalized by the second quarter of 2025.

F. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2023 (A/78/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

139. In paragraph 65 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a strategy and propose to the General Assembly ways to improve budget development for peacekeeping operations, in order to achieve greater accuracy, predictability and efficiency.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2025
Revised target date: No change

140. The 2025/26 budget will be the first to incorporate changes to reflect phase one of the new approach. The preparation process involved a careful review using a “zero-based” approach, where appropriate, bearing in mind the missions’ mandates and concept of operations. As noted previously, the Board’s recommendation will nevertheless not entail a change in the presentation of the reports of the Secretary-General, which will still reflect incremental changes related to staffing and financial resource requirements to facilitate a detailed comparative analysis of budget proposals and related expenditure. The Secretariat has started the process of preparing and presenting multi-year budget estimates for construction, and the budget supplementary documentation has been updated to reflect the first phase. The next phase will continue in line with the implementation timeline of December 2025 and will continue to be contingent on the system changes and available resourcing necessary to implement the change within missions and support entities, and may require the prioritization of some multi-year elements, with financial value taking precedence.

141. In paragraph 68 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse the sustainability of the support account, taking into

consideration the consequences of the reduction or closure of peacekeeping missions, and consolidate scalability models for both Headquarters and service centres.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

142. In accordance with General Assembly resolution [77/304](#) on the support account for peacekeeping operations, a report on the scalability of the support account will be submitted to the Assembly at its seventy-ninth session. The report provides a comprehensive analysis of interconnected issues linked to the support account, including the relative balance of work funded by the support account and the regular budget, including to the backstopping of special political missions. As part of the project, led by the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, regarding the support account and related funding issues, an external consultancy has been working with the United Nations Logistics Base and the Regional Service Centre on scalability. The findings from that review will inform future budget proposals for the United Nations Logistics Base and the Regional Service Centre, with the results expected to be included in the budget proposal for the 2026/27 period.

143. In paragraph 109 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration present, in its next report to the General Assembly on improving the financial situation of the United Nations, desirable evolutions in revenue, expenditure and liquidity management for peacekeeping operations.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

144. With regard to the recommendation on this matter and the request of the General Assembly, as set out in its resolution [76/272](#), the Secretary-General has proposed in his report on improving the financial situation of the United Nations ([A/79/734](#)) additional options for dealing with the liquidity situation, to be presented to the Assembly at its seventy-ninth session, earlier than the planned eightieth session, in view of the deteriorating liquidity situation for both the regular and peacekeeping budgets. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

145. In paragraph 141 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration define the roles and responsibilities of budget monitoring of peacekeeping operations by different stakeholders of the second line of defence to ensure that appropriate checks and balances are in place and greater attention is paid to budgetary discipline and mandate priorities.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

146. The work on defining the roles and responsibilities of the various stakeholders is under way and is on track for implementation by December 2025.

147. In paragraph 173 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration streamline and improve the quality of the data used in accountability reports produced as part of the results-based budgeting.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Department of Peace Operations and all peacekeeping missions
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

148. The first phase of implementation of this recommendation is under way, including a pilot presentation of data in budget documentation, and is on track for implementation by December 2025.

149. In paragraph 175 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a methodology to gradually build up a presentation of the main expenses according to an analytical breakdown by mandate component.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

150. The first phase of the implementation of this recommendation is under way. There are, however, significant difficulties in implementing major changes within existing resources, including the technical and operational changes that would be required to track operational costs by mandate component.

151. In paragraph 226 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the planning of the civilian component's operations to ensure, after in-depth consultations, a more realistic multi-year sequencing of the implementation of the mandate and a better alignment with strategic priorities.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2025
Revised target date: No change

152. Through the process of supporting the development or updating of mission plans across peacekeeping operations, in accordance with the forthcoming Department of Peace Operations, Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Department of Operational Support guidelines on the mission concept and mission plan, the Department of Peace Operations will work with missions to strengthen planning by peacekeeping civilian components, incorporating more rigorous processes and comprehensive documentation to support mission plans.

153. In paragraph 260 of its report, the Board recommended that the Secretariat provide information in the budget documentation on the costs of the substantive civilian component of peacekeeping operations.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2025
Revised target date: No change

154. The budget reports for the 2025/26 period are being updated to include the costs of the substantive civilian component.

155. In paragraph 304 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review and adjust existing senior mission leadership mechanisms, in line with the revised Policy on Integrated Assessment and Planning, to enhance their effectiveness in the delivery of their core integration and strategic management functions.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2025
Revised target date: No change

156. The revised Policy on Integrated Assessment and Planning (2023) has been rolled out to the missions and is being implemented. The policy establishes the minimum requirements for integration settings at both field and Headquarters levels. In the field, it is stated in the requirement that integrated field presences are required to establish a senior leadership forum for decision-making on joint strategic and operational issues that include key in-country decision makers.

157. In paragraph 341 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review, through a process including both Headquarters and the missions, the quality of the existing reporting on the performance of the

substantive civilian components of peacekeeping operations, in order to increase its relevance and better support strategic management and oversight.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2025
Revised target date: No change

158. The Department of Peace Operations will support better alignment between mission plans and Comprehensive Planning and Performance Assessment System frameworks, thereby strengthening reporting on performance and impact as part of the implementation of mission plans spanning all mission components, including specifically civilian components.

159. In paragraph 365 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration update the information on signature authority with the missions to ensure that the personnel registered correspond to the operational needs.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions
Status: Closure requested
Priority: High
Initial target date: Second quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Not applicable

160. The United Nations Treasury reached out to all field offices and received confirmation of the active bank signatories. It continues to confirm with each of the field offices when the expiration date of the delegation of authority for bank signatories has been reached in order to ensure that the signatories are still active. In addition, the Business Transformation and Accountability Division periodically monitors and informs the United Nations Treasury whenever a bank signatory has been separated or has retired from the Organization; the United Nations Treasury then withdraws the delegation of authority as bank signatory for the respective staff member. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

161. In paragraph 379 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration explore improvements on the bank reconciliation transaction in Umoja.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: Second quarter of 2025
Revised target date: No change

162. SAP has confirmed that the standard functionality does not currently allow for the automatic updating of the open item indicator in the FEBAN module (transaction

code in Umoja) on the basis of the status of the indicator at the general ledger line-item level. The Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division has reiterated that the standard general ledger line-item report already provides bank reconcilers with the information needed regarding whether an item has been reconciled (cleared) and which document it was cleared by. SAP did respond that with the Umoja EHP8 upgrade, additional t-codes may be available. A risk analysis with regard to the use of these t-codes is currently being carried out by the Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division and the Finance Division.

163. In paragraph 394 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include in the policy document mentioned in chapter II, paragraph 274, of A/77/5 (Vol. II): (a) an analysis of the possibility of differentiating the withdrawal and retirement rates at the time of retirement by participant status (international versus national); (b) a study to determine the historical rate of participants in after-service health insurance plans who leave the plan after retirement; and (c) an option that the valuation method for the full valuation be revised in the light of the results of these analyses.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

164. The recommended analysis is ongoing and the Administration will discuss the progress and review the timeline with the Board during the next interim audit.

165. In paragraph 418 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish in a formal document the process for determining the peacekeeping operations' shares of the various after-service health insurance medical plans, specifying in particular the internal controls to be implemented.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

166. Development of the recommended document is ongoing. Relevant internal control and process flow elements are being formalized and tested, with completion of the documentation expected by the end of 2025.

167. In paragraph 429 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a standard operating procedure for the credit returns to Member States that provides an overview of the process and the related internal controls.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

168. Implementation of the recommendation is still ongoing; the target date has been revised to the second quarter of 2025.

169. In paragraph 454 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the cost-recovery accumulated surpluses of UNMISS, UNSOS, the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic, MONUSCO and the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei and make the necessary adjustments.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, UNMISS, UNSOS, United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic, MONUSCO and United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2026

170. The Administration has been requested by the General Assembly to provide to the Assembly at its eightieth session a comprehensive report on cost recovery. The detailed review of the fund balances will therefore be delayed in order to prepare the requested report.

171. In paragraph 459 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue its work on centrally monitoring cost recovery in particular to ensure the correct differentiation between spendable and non-spendable income.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, MONUSCO and UNMISS
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

172. The Administration provided guidance to missions on the classification of spendable and non-spendable revenue. Information on classification of revenue is provided in closing instructions, training courses and policy guidance. The missions' finance staff are instructed to review the classifications prior to the closure of accounts at the end of the financial year and to make any required corrections. The Administration will continue its central review of the cost recovery funds as part of its normal scope of work and the information will be made available on the dashboard.

The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

173. In paragraph 485 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration complete its review of the fuel category strategy in a timely manner to adapt it to various challenges, including by exploring additional contract tools and operating models in order to reduce its dependence on a very limited number of suppliers.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

174. The review of the fuel category strategy is in progress, with the aim of reducing dependency on a limited number of suppliers. As part of the review, two vendor outreach events (vendor round-tables) were held in Mogadishu and in Mombasa, Kenya, from 28 October to 1 November 2024. Inputs have been gathered from vendors, through surveys on market capacity and feedback, that support the proposed revision of the strategy. The required document is under preparation for review by and the approval of management.

175. In paragraph 538 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure better anticipation and mitigation by peacekeeping missions of the risks associated with a withdrawal.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Closure requested
Priority: High
Initial target date: First quarter of 2025
Revised target date: Not applicable

176. Peacekeeping operations are required to develop comprehensive mission plans outlining key deliverables related to transition and withdrawal processes. These plans include a dedicated section on risk analysis so as to ensure thorough planning for and mitigation of potential challenges. In addition, the Business Transformation and Accountability Division conducted site visits in 2024 to two peacekeeping missions – MONUSCO and UNSOS. The risks associated with withdrawal were discussed with the risk owners, the local enterprise risk management committees and the special representatives of the Secretary-General. The Administration considers this recommendation to have been implemented and requests its closure by the Board.